

Boeing's Starliner astronauts optimistic about safe return despite technical hurdles

Two astronauts who were supposed to return to Earth weeks ago expressed confidence on Wednesday that Boeing's space



capsule can bring them back safely, despite encountering several technical issues.

NASA test pilots Butch Wilmore and Suni Williams launched aboard

Boeing's new Starliner capsule early last month, the first people to ride it. However, helium leaks and problems with thrusters almost prevented their arrival at the International Space Station (ISS) and have prolonged their stay. They now may not return until the end of July, officials said. During their first news conference from space, Wilmore and Williams said they expect to return once tests on the thrusters are completed on Earth (via The Associated Press). They expressed satisfaction with the extra time in orbit, enjoying their roles in assisting the station crew. Both astronauts have previous experience on the ISS.

<https://bit.ly/In2thestars>



NASA warns about 130-foot asteroid moving towards Earth

NASA constantly monitors all upcoming near-Earth objects (NEOs), including asteroids and comets. While many of these objects pass by the Earth at a safe distance, some are watched closely due to their potential risk. One such recently discovered space rock is asteroid 2024 ME1. Measuring a massive 130-foot in size—comparable to an aeroplane—this asteroid is making its closest approach to Earth today, July 10th.

According to data from NASA's Jet Propulsion Laboratory (JPL), asteroid 2024 ME1 will be approximately 2.7 million miles from Earth. While this may seem like a significant distance, in astronomical terms, it is relatively close—just 0.029 AU away. Additionally, 2024 ME1 is hurtling towards Earth at a staggering speed of 30,217 kilometres per hour, which is about 24.5 times the speed of sound! Classified as an Amor asteroid, it belongs to a group of near-Earth asteroids named after the archetype object 1221 Amor, reports Times Now.

<https://bit.ly/AstraScare>

Thirty Metre Telescope project and India's role in it

India, the United States, Canada, China, and Japan are working on a groundbreaking international initiative focused on exploring space and the universe. Known as the Thirty Metre Telescope (TMT), this ambitious project marks a significant collaboration poised to transform our understanding of space.

Featuring a 30-metre primary mirror and advanced adaptive optics, the TMT promises to unveil cosmic objects with unprecedented clarity, pushing the boundaries of scientific discovery. The Thirty Metre Telescope is a massive telescope designed to unlock some of the uni-



verse's most profound mysteries. It aims to explore the formation of the first galaxies and stars post-Big Bang, the evolution of galaxies, the dynamics between supermassive black holes and their galaxies, star and planetary system formation, and the characteristics of planets outside the solar system (via Firstpost). <https://bit.ly/3MTSIND>